

Product Vision

Semantic Memory of kivi

What I noticed

Every product that keeps memories has chosen, often without saying it out loud, what kind of relationship it wants with its user. That relationship is what gives it permission to remember.

A keyboard wants to live in muscle memory. So it picks up your typing patterns and nothing more than that. A note-taking app wants to act like a scribe. It stores a true copy of what you write but never tries to read between the lines. A general helper wants to be someone you trust. That closeness lets it hold onto your moods, your health updates, and your personal connections - most of it saved without you asking.

Right now Kivi works like a keyboard. Its style settings and phonetic memory are all about muscle memory. They make dictation feel like yours without needing to know anything personal. Semantic memory is where Kivi picks what relationship it steps into next.

It should take on the role of a scribe (not a confidant).

What Kivi should become

A long-lasting record of everything a person creates that they can come back and ask questions about.

Where the value is created

Kivi picks up everything someone writes, across every app they use. Slack only remembers what happens inside Slack. Gmail only remembers Gmail. No other tool inside the operating system sees the full picture of what a person produces during their day.

This means the real value isn't about personalization. It's about keeping things connected between different tools. Someone makes a choice in Slack on Monday. Then they explain that same choice in an email on Wednesday. By the time March rolls around and it really matters those pieces exist as three separate fragments they can't find anymore. Kivi sits in a spot where it can hold all three pieces and return them as one complete answer.

That kind of help is worth more than a system that knows what hobbies someone has.

What deserves to be remembered

Things a person wrote that last longer than the moment they wrote them. Things like projects and where they stand right now. Who owns what. Decisions people made and when those decisions shifted. Commitments people made plus their deadlines. And the specific words that belong to this person's work - names of projects, coworkers, and vendors.

What Kivi must never assume

Hearing someone speak does not mean you get to copy how they sound.

Kivi should never guess from how a person talks - things like their mood, stress level, health, confidence, or personality. Dictation records people thinking out loud; they say things to their laptop they would never type into a search box. A speech company has a unique chance to make these kinds of guesses, and that is exactly why saying no to it is a choice, not a shortcoming.

Kivi must never hold onto information about other people. Dictation is full of unfiltered comments about coworkers who are not users and never agreed to be recorded. Kivi notes that Priya manages the design system. It does not note what you think about her.

Kivi must never treat a single unclear mention as a confirmed fact, and it must never quietly change what dictation writes down. Normal dictation follows one rule: what you said is what shows up. Memory might add learned names into phonetic correction, or pop up a visible suggestion. It never changes things without asking.

Why someone should trust this enough to keep using it

Three things, and you can check each one.

Everything Kivi knows sits in one spot, written in plain language, right next to the dictations that created it. Every answer points to the actual words the person said. And when the history does not have an answer, Kivi says so and tells you what it does have, instead of making up something that sounds believable.

Control happens right where the memory shows up - you can correct it, pin it, or delete it at that moment, not inside a settings menu. Forgetting still works even if you process things again.

What this position forbids

Guessing someone's emotional state. Building a map of coworkers' relationships. Memory that comes up on its own without being asked. A personality model that changes what gets typed. Learning from one user and applying it to another.

Each of these is possible to build. Each one would turn Kivi into something people install once and then just watch.